
COLLEGE CHORAL SERIES

CCS004



mó ghile meAR

arranged by
DESMOND EARLEY

COLLEGE CHORAL SERIES

College Choral Series is a collection of contemporary choral music featuring imaginative and stimulating arrangements of traditional Irish music and original compositions based on Irish texts. The series is published in association with the Choral Scholars of University College Dublin. Selections from the collection have been recorded by the choir for Signum Records and feature on the albums *Invisible Stars* (SIGCD436) and *Perpetual Twilight* (SIGCD558). These highly acclaimed recordings feature traditional and contemporary choral music from Ireland and Scotland, including new arrangements and compositions by some of Ireland’s most celebrated composers.

LYRICS - MO GHILE MEAR

mə ʒɪlʲɪ məɹ

Curfá

‘Sé mo laoch mo ghile mear
‘Sé mo Shaesar, gile mear,
Ní bhfuairesas féin aon tsuan ná séan,
Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghile mear.

ʃe mə ʃeəx mə ʒɪlʲɪ məɹ
ʃe mə hezəɹ ʒɪlʲɪ məɹ
nʲi vuəɹʲəs feɲʲ* eɲ tʲu eɲ nʲo ʃeɲ */heɲʲ
o xuɹ ɪ ʃeɲʲ mə ʒɪlʲɪ məɹ

Bímse buan ar buairt gach ló,
Ag caoi go crua is ag tuar na ndeor
Mar scaoileadh uaim an buachaill beo
Is ná ríomhtar tuairisc uaidh, mo bhrón.

bimʲʃə buəɲ eɹʲ buəɹʲɪ ɡax ʃo
eɪ ɡə ɡə kruə seɪ tʲu əɹ nʲə nʲoɹ
mɑɹ skəɪlʲəx wɛmʲ əɲ buəxəɹʲ bʲo
sɲo ɹəɪvtə ɹ tʲu tʲɪʃc wai mə vɹoɲ

Curfá

Ní haoibhinn cuach ba suairc ar neoin
Táid fíorchoin uaisle ar uathne spórt
Táid saoithe suaite i mbuairt ‘s i mbrón
Ó scaoileadh uaim an buachaill beo

nʲi hivaɲʲ kʲuəx bə suɪɹc eɹ nʲoɲʲ
tʲo ɹʲ fɪɹxʲɪɲʲ uʲʃɪ eɹ uɪɲɲɪ spɔɹt
tʲo ɹʲ səɪtʲɪ suɪtʲɪ ɪ muɹʲ sɪ mɹoɲ
o skəɪlʲəx wɛmʲ əɲ buəxɪɹʲ bɔɲ

Curfá

Is cosúil é le hAonghus Óg,
Le Lughaidh Mac Chéin na mbéimeann mór,
Le Cú Raoi, ardmhac Dáire an óir,
Taoiseach Éireann tréan ar tóir

ɪs kʲɪsuɹʲ e ʲe heɲɡəs ɔɡ
ʲe lʲu ɪ mak ɹeɲʲ nʲə meməɲ moɹ
ʲe ku ɹəɪ ɹɹɹwɹk ɹɹɹɹɹ eɲ oɹʲ
tʲɪ ʃəx eɹʲəɲ tʲɪeɲ eɹ to tʲɪ

Curfá

Le Conall Cearnach bhearnadh poirt,
Le Fearghas fiúntach fionn Mac Róigh
Le Conchubhar cáidhmhac Náis na nós,
Taoiseach aoibhinn Chraoibhe an cheoil.

ʲe kʲɪnəɹ cəɹɲəx vəɹɲəx pɹɹʲ
ʲe fɹɹɡəs fʲuɲtə x fʲuɲ mak ɹoɪ
ʲe kʲɪɹɹuɹ kɔɪwɹk nʲɹɹ nʲə nʲos
tʲɪ ʃəx ivaɲʲ xuɪvə eɲ ɹoɹʲ

PROGRAMME NOTE - MO GHILE MEAR

Written by the eighteenth-century poet Seán Clárach Mac Dómhnaill, Mo Ghile Mear is a traditional allegorical song—similar to the Gaelic poetic form of the Aisling—in which the poet laments the departure of Prince Charles Edward Stuart (Bonnie Prince Charlie). As is customary, the poetic text portrays the land in decline in his absence. The drum used in this arrangement is the Irish single-headed frame drum, the bodhrán, but an alternative hand-played frame drum may be used as a substitute.

Mo Ghile Mear

for Tenor Solo, S.A.T.T.B.B. voices and Bodhrán

TRADITIONAL IRISH

Words by
SEÁN CLÁRACH MAC DÓMHNAILL (18th c.)

Arranged by
DESMOND EARLEY (b.1974)

Freely

TENOR
(Solo)

PIANO
(for rehearsal only)

Solo

A

A

T

B

A

The musical score is written for a Tenor Solo, Piano, and SATTB.B. voices. The key signature is three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat) and the time signature is 4/4. The score begins with a 'Freely' marking and a piano (p) dynamic. The Tenor Solo part has lyrics: 'S é mo laoch mo Ghi-le mear, 'S é mo Shae-sar, ghi-le mear, Ní fhua - ras féin aon tsuan ná séan, Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - le. The Piano part provides accompaniment. The SATTB.B. voices enter with a 'div.' (divisi) marking and a piano (p) dynamic, with lyrics: mear. 'S é mo laoch mo Ghi-le mear, 'S é mo Shae - sar, Mm. The score includes a 'Bodhrán' part (labeled 'A') which is a rhythmic accompaniment. The score is marked with 'A' and 'B' for rehearsal points.

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Solo

ghí-le_____ mear, Ní fhua - ras féin aon tsuan ná séan, Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo_ghí - le

S

mo ghí - le

A

mo ghí - le

T

mo ghí - le

B

mo ghí - le

12

16

Bodhrán

♩. = 60

B

Generally **f**, third verse **mp**

Solo

mear.

1. Bím - se buan ar
2. Ní haoi - bhinn cuach ba
3. Is co - súil é le
4. Le Con - all Cear - nach

S

mear.

A

mear.

T

mear.

B

mear.

16

♩. = 60

B

19

Bodhrán

Solo

buairt gach ló, Ag caoi go crua is' tuar na ndeor, Mar
 suairc ar neoin, Táid fíor - choín uas - al ar ua - tha sport, Táid
 hAon - ghús Óg, Le Lughaidh Mac Chéin na mbéim - eann mór, Le
 bhear - nadh poirt, Le Fear - ghas fiún - tach fionn Mac Róigh, Le

22

Bodhrán

Solo

scaoil - eadh uaim an bua - chaill beo, Is ná ríomh - tar tuair - isc
 saoi - te suai - te i mbuairt is' mbrón, Ó - scaoil - eadh uaim an
 Cú Raoi, ard - mhac Dá - re an óir, — Taoi - seach Éir - eann
 Con - chubar cáidh - mhac Náis na nós, — Taoi - seach aoi - bhinn

25

Bodhrán

Solo

uaidh mo bhrón. 'Sé mo laoch mo ghi-le mear,
 buach - aill beo. toir.
 tréan ar cheoil.
 Chraoibhe an cheoil.

C Curfá/Chorus

— bodhrán tacet on chorus of verse 3 from here to end of ms. 32,
 resuming on downbeat of ms. 33

S

A

T

B

Generally *f*, third verse *mp*

Generally *f*, third verse *mp*

Generally *f*, third verse *mp*

Generally *f*, third verse *mp*

25

C

28

Bodhrán

Solo

S

A

T

B

'Sé mo Shae - sar ghi-le mear, Ní fhuar - as féin aon

28

31

Bodhrán

Solo

S

A

T

B

tsuan ná séan, Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - ³ le

tsuan ná séan, Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - ³ le

tsuan ná séan, Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - le

unis.

tsuan ná séan, Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - le

tsuan ná séan, Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - le

31

33 1.2.3. 4.

Bodhrán *[bodhrán resumes (v.3)]*

Solo

S

A

T

B

36

Solo

S

A

T

B

36

mear. ghi - le mear. 'Sé mo laoch mo
 mear. ghi - le mear. 'Sé mo laoch mo
 mear. ghi - le mear. 'Sé mo laoch mo
 mear. ghi - le mear. 'Sé mo laoch mo
 mear. ghi - le mear. 'Sé mo laoch mo
 ghi-le mear, 'Sé mo Shae - sar ghi-le mear, Ní
 ghi-le mear, 'Sé mo Shae - sar ghi-le mear, Ní
 ghi-le mear, 'Sé mo Shae - sar ghi-le mear, Ní
 ghi-le mear, 'Sé mo Shae - sar ghi-le mear, Ní
 ghi-le mear, 'Sé mo Shae - sar ghi-le mear, Ní

with Choir **poco rit.**

Bodhrán 39

Solo

fhuar - as féin aon tsuan ar séan Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - le

S

fhuar - as féin aon tsuan ar séan Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - le

A

fhuar - as féin aon tsuan ar séan Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - le

T

fhuar - as féin aon tsuan ar séan Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - le

B

fhuar - as féin aon tsuan ar séan Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - le

poco rit.

Adagio

Bodhrán 42

Solo

mear. Ó chuaigh i gcéin mo ghi - le mear.

S

mear. Mm

A

mear. Mm

T

mear. Mm

B

mear. Mm

Didgeridoo!

Adagio

Mo Ghile Mear

for Tenor Solo, S.A.T.T.B. voices and Bodhrán

TRADITIONAL IRISH

Arranged by

DESMOND EARLEY (b.1974)

BODHRÁN

Freely

A

6 7 6

16 $\text{♩} = 60$ **B** *Generally **f**, third verse **mp***

19

22

C **Curfá/Chorus**

25

— *bodhrán tacet on chorus of verse 3 from here to end of ms. 32, resuming on downbeat of ms. 33*

28

31

1. 2. 3. 4.

[*bodhrán resumes (v.3)*]

36

with Choir

39 **poco rit.**

Adagio

42

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ABOUT THE CHORAL SCHOLARS OF UNIVERSITY COLLEGE DUBLIN

The Choral Scholars of University College Dublin is an internationally-acclaimed chamber choir of gifted student singers led by founding Artistic Director, Dr Desmond Earley, based at University College Dublin School of Music. With a classical focus, and an inspiration found in the music and literature of Ireland, the ensemble's repertoire ranges from contemporary choral music to the re-imagining of Irish traditional song. The choir has a working relationship with national and international ensembles, performing with the Irish Chamber Orchestra, RTÉ Concert Orchestra and the European Union Chamber Orchestra, and has toured The Netherlands, Hungary, Luxembourg, Italy, the UK and the eastern states of the USA. The Choral Scholars are committed to artistic excellence, an ambitious vision, a joyful camaraderie, and a dynamic, youthful sound.

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'UCD Choral Scholars is one of the finest college choirs I have ever heard on my travels: such fabulous intonation, blend and musicality. Desmond Earley's arrangements for this group would be a fine addition to the library of any choir.'

Nigel Short - Artistic Director of the UK professional choir **Tenebrae**

PUBLISHING EDITOR

Mark Armstrong is one of Ireland's foremost choral specialists and his extensive catalogue of arrangements and compositions for choir, orchestra and concert band have received critical acclaim worldwide. In a career spanning thirty years he has performed and recorded with all of Ireland's major amateur and professional choral and instrumental ensembles and enjoys adjudicating at choral festivals in Ireland and abroad.

SERIES EDITOR

Dr Desmond Earley is Assistant Professor of Choral Music at University College Dublin and Artistic Director of the Choral Scholars of University College Dublin.

He is a published arranger and composer of works with Hal Leonard (USA), Alliance (USA), Seolta Music (IRL) and Novello (UK), and frequently works as a choral conductor and clinician in the areas of early music and Irish music.



ISMN 979-0-708143-03-1

Published by Seolta Music Limited
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